Student activity

Think: Crossed cheque is preferred to a bearer cheque. Why?

3.3 Double entry system

Double entry system of book keeping is a scientific and complete system of recording the financial transactions of an organisation. According to this system, every transaction has a two fold effect. That is, there are two aspects involved, namely, receiving aspect and giving aspect. It is denoted by debit (Dr.) and credit (Cr.). The basic principle of double entry system is that for every debit there must be an equivalent and corresponding credit. Debit denotes an increase in assets or expenses or a decrease in liabilities, income or capital. Credit denotes an increase in liabilities, income or capital or a decrease in assets or expenses.



'Dr.' is abbreviation of 'addebitare', the Italian word and debere, the Latin word meaning 'debit'. Hence, though there is no 'r' in the word debit. It has been abbreviated as 'Dr.' based on the Italian and Latin words having 'r' in these.

3.3.1 Definition

"Every transaction involving money or money's worth has two fold aspects, the receiving of a value on the one hand and the giving of the same value on the other. This two fold nature in all transactions must be recorded in the books and this gives rise to the term Double Entry Book keeping".

– Munro and Palmer

"Every business transaction has a two-fold effect and that it affects two accounts in opposite directions and if a complete record is to be made of each such transaction it is necessary to debit one account and credit another account. It is this recording of two fold effect of every transaction that has given rise to the term Double Entry".

– J.R Batliboi

3.3.2 Principles of double entry system

Following are the principles of double entry system:

(i) In every business transaction, there are two aspects.

(ii) The two aspects involved are the benefit or value receiving aspect and benefit or value giving aspect.

(iii) These two aspects involve minimum two accounts; at least one debit and at least one credit.

(iv) For every debit, there is a corresponding and equivalent credit. If one account is debited the other account must be credited.

3.3.3 Advantages of double entry system

Following are the advantages of double entry system:

(i) Accuracy

In this system, the two aspects of each transaction are recorded in the books of accounts. This helps in checking the accuracy in accounting.

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